

Blog Writing Guide - MoreThanOneWay.org

How to Add a New Blog Post

This guide walks you through writing and publishing a new blog post step-by-step.

Quick Overview

Time required: 30-45 minutes (mostly writing)

Files to edit: Just `posts.js`

Deployment: 2 commands (build + deploy)

Step-by-Step Process

Step 1: Write Your Content

Write in Google Docs first (easier than coding directly):

- Use normal formatting (bold, italics, headings)
- Write naturally - you'll convert to markdown later
- Aim for 800-1500 words (good for SEO)
- Include 2-3 internal links to your site pages

Content tips:

- Start with a hook (relatable problem or question)
 - Use short paragraphs (3-4 sentences max)
 - Break up text with headings every 200-300 words
 - End with a call-to-action or encouragement
-

Step 2: Open posts.js

Location: `C:\Users\msrop\OneDrive\Documents\morethanoneway-main\src\posts.js`

Open with: Notepad or your code editor

Step 3: Copy the Template

Find the last post in the `posts` array and copy this structure:

```
javascript
```

```

{
  id: 4, // ← Increment from last post (if last was 3, use 4)
  title: "Your Post Title Here",
  slug: "your-post-title-here", // ← Used in URL (lowercase, hyphens)
  date: "January 20, 2025",
  category: "Career", // Career, Academics, or Mental Health
  tags: ["keyword1", "keyword2", "keyword3"],
  excerpt: "One sentence summary that shows on blog page (150 chars max).",
  author: "MoreThanOneWay Team",
  readTime: "5 min read", // Estimate: 200 words = 1 minute
  featured: false, // Set ONE post to true (featured = big card on blog page)
  image: null, // Optional: "/images/blog/filename.jpg"
  content: `
# Your Main Title

Your first paragraph goes here...

## Subheading

More content...

[Link to internal page](/study-resources)
`,
},

```

Important: Add a comma after the closing `}` if there are more posts below!

Step 4: Fill in the Metadata

id:

- Increment from the last post
- Example: If last post is `(id: 3)`, make this `(id: 4)`

title:

- What appears at top of post
- Example: `"I Failed My First CS Class - Here's What I Did"`

slug:

- Used in URL: `morethanoneway.org/blog/your-slug-here`
- Use lowercase letters, numbers, and hyphens only

- Include keywords for SEO
- Example: `"failing-cs-class"`

date:

- Format: `"Month Day, Year"`
- Example: `"January 20, 2025"`

category:

- Choose ONE: `"Career"`, `"Academics"`, or `"Mental Health"`
- Determines tag color (Career=blue, Academics=green, Mental Health=purple)

tags:

- Array of 3-5 keywords
- Used for search functionality
- Include what students might search
- Example: `["job search", "internships", "rejection", "career advice"]`

excerpt:

- Short summary (1-2 sentences, max 160 characters)
- Shows on blog listing page
- Also used for SEO meta description
- Example: `"The honest truth about entry-level job hunting that career services won't tell you."`

readTime:

- Estimate: ~200 words per minute
- Example: 1000-word post = `"5 min read"`

featured:

- `true` or `false`
- Only ONE post should be `featured: true` at a time
- Featured posts appear in large card at top of blog page

image:

- `null` (no image) OR

- `"/images/blog/your-image.jpg"` (if you add image)
 - Images go in `public/images/blog/` folder
-

Step 5: Write Content in Markdown

Inside the backticks (```), write your content using markdown formatting:

Headings:

markdown

`#` Main Title (H1 - only use once at top)

`##` Section Heading (H2)

`###` Subsection (H3)

Text Formatting:

markdown

`**Bold text**`

`*Italic text*`

Lists:

markdown

Bullet list:

- First item

- Second item

- Third item

Numbered list:

1. First step

2. Second step

3. Third step

Links:

Internal links (to your site pages):

markdown

[View study resources](/study-resources)

[Find internships](/find-internships)

[Crisis support](/crisis)

External links:

markdown

[External site](https://example.com)

IMPORTANT Internal Link Mapping: Your site pages use these URLs:

- `/study-resources` → Study Resources page
- `/crisis` → Crisis Resources page
- `/stories` → Real Stories page
- `/find-internships` → Find Internships page
- `/resume-builder` → Resume Builder page
- `/search-guide` → Search Guide page
- `/interview-prep` → Interview Prep page
- `/youre-not-alone` → You're Not Alone page
- `/job-tools` → Job Tools Hub page
- `/tracker` → Application Tracker page

Blockquotes:

markdown

> Important callout text

Horizontal Line:

markdown

Tables:

markdown

Column 1	Column 2	Column 3
-----	-----	-----
Data	Data	Data
Data	Data	Data

Step 6: Add Internal Links

Every post should link to 2-3 relevant site pages.

Examples:

- Career posts → Link to Find Internships, Job Tools, Resume Builder
- Academics posts → Link to Study Resources
- Mental health posts → Link to Crisis Resources, You're Not Alone, Stories

Why this matters:

- Helps students find more resources
- Good for SEO (Google likes internal linking)
- Keeps users on your site longer

Step 7: Save the File

Important:

- Save as `posts.js` (not `.txt`)
- Make sure you didn't accidentally delete any commas or brackets
- Check that all backticks (``) are closed

Step 8: Test Locally (Recommended)

```
bash
```

```
cd C:\Users\msrop\OneDrive\Documents\morethanoneway-main
```

```
npm run dev
```

Visit: `http://localhost:5173/blog`

Check:

- ☒ Your new post appears in the list

- ☒ Category tag is correct color
- ☒ Click through to full post
- ☒ All formatting looks good
- ☒ Internal links work
- ☒ No typos

Press `Ctrl+C` to stop dev server when done.

Step 9: Deploy

```
bash  
  
npm run build  
npm run deploy
```

Wait 2-3 minutes, then visit: `morethanoneway.org/blog`

Your post is live! 🎉

Complete Example Post

```
javascript
```

```
{
  id: 4,
  title: "How I Switched Majors Junior Year and Still Graduated On Time",
  slug: "switching-majors-junior-year",
  date: "January 25, 2025",
  category: "Career",
  tags: ["major change", "career pivot", "college advice"],
  excerpt: "Switching majors isn't the end of the world. Here's how one student made it work without adding extra years.",
  author: "MoreThanOneWay Team",
  readTime: "6 min read",
  featured: false,
  image: null,
  content: `
```

How I Switched Majors Junior Year and Still Graduated On Time

Sarah was halfway through her CS degree when she realized she hated programming.

Not "this is hard" hate. Real, "I dread opening my laptop" hate.

But everyone told her: "You're too far in to quit now." "You'll waste two years." "Just finish the degree."

She switched anyway. Here's what happened.

The Breaking Point

Junior year, fall semester. Sarah had a 3.7 GPA in Computer Science. From the outside, she was thriving.

Inside? She was miserable.

Every coding assignment felt like torture. She'd watch her classmates get excited about algorithms while she felt... nothing. Ju

****The wake-up call:**** A panic attack before her Data Structures midterm.

She realized: "I can't do this for 30 more years."

What She Did

1. Talked to Academic Advising

Sarah met with her academic advisor expecting them to discourage her.

Instead, they helped her run a degree audit:

- ****Credits earned:**** 87

- **Credits needed for graduation:** 120
- **Credits that could transfer to other majors:** 62

Key insight: Her math, science, and general education credits would count toward almost any major.

2. Researched Overlapping Majors

She looked for majors where her existing credits would count:

- ☒ **Information Systems** (tech-adjacent, less coding)
- ☒ **Data Analytics** (uses her math background)
- ☒ **Business with Tech Minor** (different path, some credits transfer)
- ☒ Art History (too many required courses, would take 2+ extra years)

She chose Information Systems - still tech-related but focused on business applications, not pure coding.

3. Made a Graduation Plan

With her advisor, Sarah mapped out remaining semesters:

- Spring junior year: 15 credits (catch-up courses)
- Summer session: 6 credits (online)
- Fall senior year: 15 credits
- Spring senior year: 15 credits

Total: She'd graduate on time with her original class.

Cost: One summer session tuition (~\$2,000)

4. Handled the Mental Hurdles

Hardest parts:

- Telling her parents (they'd been bragging about their "CS daughter")
- Explaining to peers ("You're quitting CS?!")
- Facing the sunk cost fallacy ("I already spent 2 years...")

What helped:

- Therapy through campus counseling
- Connecting with students who'd also switched majors
- Remembering: 2 wasted years < 30 years in wrong career

[Mental health support resources](/youre-not-alone)

What Happened

Sarah graduated on time with a degree in Information Systems.

****Her first job:**** IT consultant at a mid-size company. She works with technology but doesn't code all day. She actually enjoys it.

****Looking back:**** "Switching was the best decision I made. Yes, I 'wasted' two years. But I'd have wasted my entire twenties if I hadn't."

If You're Considering Switching

Ask yourself:

****Is it just hard, or is it wrong?****

- Hard: You struggle but still find it interesting
- Wrong: You dread it even when you're doing well

****What would make you excited to learn?****

- If you can't answer this, that's a sign to explore

****Can you see yourself doing this in 5 years?****

- If the answer is "I hope not," listen to that

Do this:

1. ****Run a degree audit**** (academic advising office)
2. ****Research major requirements**** (see what transfers)
3. ****Talk to students in other majors**** (what's it really like?)
4. ****Consider overlap majors**** (Information Systems, Data Science, Business Analytics)
5. ****Make a graduation timeline**** (can you still graduate on time?)

[Explore career paths](/search-guide)

Don't do this:

- ✗ Switch without a plan (you might add years)
- ✗ Let sunk cost fallacy trap you (2 years < lifetime)
- ✗ Pick a major just because it's "easier"
- ✗ Ignore your mental health

Common Concerns

****"I'll disappoint my parents"*****

- They'd rather you be happy than miserable with a "prestigious" degree
- You can't live your parents' dreams

****"I wasted two years"*****

- Better 2 years than 30 in wrong career

- Credits often transfer - not actually "wasted"

***"What will people think?"**

- They'll forget in 6 months

- Your happiness matters more than their opinions

"I'll be behind my peers"

- Everyone's timeline is different

- Graduating "on time" in wrong major $\neq$ success

Resources

***Academic advising:**

- Schedule ASAP (don't wait until add/drop deadline)

- Ask for degree audit

- Bring list of questions

***Career exploration:**

- [Find what interests you](/search-guide)

- [Career resources](/job-tools)

***Mental health support:**

- Campus counseling (usually free)

- [Crisis resources if you're struggling](/crisis)

You Have More Options Than You Think

Switching majors isn't failure. It's self-awareness.

Sarah's story isn't unique. Every semester, students realize they're in the wrong major. Some switch. Some don't.

The ones who switch? They're usually happier.

The ones who don't? They often end up switching careers later anyway - but with student debt and regret.

***You're allowed to change your mind.** That's not weakness. That's wisdom.

Considering a change? [Read more stories from students who switched](/stories)

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Writing Tips

Keep It Real

- Use honest language ("I cried. A lot.")
- Acknowledge hard truths
- Don't sugarcoat the struggle

Make It Actionable

- Include specific steps
- Link to resources
- Give examples they can follow

Show, Don't Tell

- Use numbers/data when possible
- Tell stories, not generic advice
- Include real examples

SEO Best Practices

- Use keywords naturally in title and headings
 - Include internal links (helps Google understand site structure)
 - Write 800+ words (longer posts rank better)
 - Use descriptive slugs with keywords
-

Troubleshooting

Problem: Syntax error when saving **Solution:** Check for:

- Missing comma after post object
- Unclosed backticks (`)
- Unclosed brackets or braces

Problem: Post not showing up **Solution:**

- Make sure post is inside the `posts` array
- Check that you saved the file
- Run `npm run build` again

- Clear browser cache (Ctrl+Shift+R)

Problem: Formatting looks wrong **Solution:**

- Check markdown syntax (# for headings, ** for bold, etc.)
- Make sure backticks are properly closed
- Test locally with `npm run dev`

Problem: Links not working **Solution:**

- Internal links must start with / (like `/crisis`)
 - Check spelling of page URLs
 - Refer to "Internal Link Mapping" section above
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Need Help?

- Check `BLOG_TROUBLESHOOTING.md` for common issues
 - Check `BLOG_README.md` for technical details
 - Email support@morethanoneway.org
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You've got this! Start with your first post and learn as you go. 🚀